Q: Secretary Rubio, you have spoken about America's efforts to reindustrialise. In that context, shouldn't the US be welcoming highly skilled Indian professionals, as it has in the past, rather than raising the cost of work visas and making it more expensive for Indian students to study in America?

Rubio: There is a change in our immigration laws, and it's not one that's built or focused on India. It happens to impact Indians that want to come to the United States and work and that our businesses are trying to bring in, but it's not geared towards India. It is global. In fact, there's no meeting in the world I do that doesn't raise some visa issue. The United States has had a broken immigration system. We've had a system, maybe not in this programme but in others, we had 20 million people unlawfully enter the country across our border. We've had business-related immigration programmes where fraud and abuse have been rampant in several cases and have been misused in ways that have not made sense. We have tensions in our own society. What country in the world would not have its people react if they see some of their best jobs going to people coming from abroad? So, these things have to be addressed, and we're trying to address them, but they're not aimed at India. They apply to every country in the world. That's true on trade. That's true on immigration. I know that a country disproportionately impacted by a policy change in the United States may feel like it's being targeted, but it's not. We are going to get it right, and we're going to have a system that works for our economy and for the American people. In the end, I will say this. I expect the government of India will always put the people of India first and that you will always put the national interest of India first. But I also hope everyone understands that the United States under President Trump is going to put our people first, our workers first, and our country first. And where friends can work together is when there are differences on this, our existing, our common interests, our long-standing relationship, and our shared values will allow us to work through some of those differences to reach outcomes that are positive for both countries.

Gor: The Secretary is 100 per cent right. When we talk about America First, it doesn't mean America alone. And to the Secretary's point, all these items that have changed that have impacted India, it's not just India. It's the whole world, that the United States needed to take a look at. For too long, we had open borders. For too long, people were coming into the United States and taking advantage of us. We had leaders on both sides of the political aisle that did not look out for the American people. That changed under President Trump. That doesn't mean it's targeting any individual country. We need a reset. The Prime Minister's been very clear here, India First. There's nothing wrong with that. He should be looking out for his own country. But people shouldn't be

"In no way does our relationship with Pakistan come at the expense of our relationship with India. We share the same concerns as India on terrorism. We have been victims of terrorism, so has India"
— RUBIO



"President Trump is not an orthodox political figure, he's a man of business who takes decisions based on what makes sense. He's a visionary who first imagines what people say is impossible, and then achieves them"
— RUBIO